
Paper 2, Option 2D.2:

The unification of Germany, c1840–71

Overview

This option comprises a study in depth of the German states in the 1840s, through the failure of the revolutions of 1848–49, to the decline of Austrian power and the creation of a new German state under the leadership of Prussia in the years to 1871.

Students will gain an in-depth understanding of the nature and extent of change in this period, nationalist challenges and conservative resistance, and how Prussia used its economic and military power to remove Austrian influence within Germany and establish itself as the dominant German power by 1871.

Key topics	Content
1 Popular pressure and causes of revolution, 1840–48	• The political situation in the 1840s: political geography of the German Confederation; the dominance of Austria; the growth of nationalism, including the 1840 crisis; growth of liberalism; Prussia under Frederick William IV. • Economic and social developments in the 1840s: economic divisions; economic dominance of Prussia; significance of railway building and the <i>Zollverein</i>; impact of urbanisation and industrialisation on social classes. • Short-term causes of revolution, 1846–48: economic crisis, 1846–47; growing popular unrest; middle-class nationalism and liberalism; constitutional crisis in Baden; impact of revolution in France. • Outbreak of revolution in 1848; revolution in the German states and response of the German rulers; reasons for initial success; situation in Austrian Empire.
2 Failure of revolution, 1848–51	• The Frankfurt Parliament, 1848–49: <i>Vorparlament</i>; the nature and work of the Frankfurt Assembly, including disagreements and the Fifty Articles; the collapse of the Assembly; significance of weaknesses and political divisions. • Revolution in Prussia, 1848–49: events in Berlin and the response of Frederick William IV; liberal government, conservative reaction and counter-revolution; the Prussian constitution. • Reasons for failure of the revolutions: counter-revolution and the strength of conservative forces across Germany; the revival of Habsburg power in Austria; weaknesses of, and divisions amongst, revolutionaries.

Key topics	Content
3 Austro-Prussian rivalry, 1852–66	• Austrian strengths and weaknesses: political influence in Germany; economic and financial problems; rejection from the <i>Zollverein</i>; international setbacks. • Economic developments in Prussia: development of the <i>Zollverein</i>; financial strength; increased industrial production and agricultural reform; expansion of railways and state investment. • Political developments in Prussia: Manteuffel's reforms; liberal-nationalism and the <i>Nationalverein</i>; regency and accession of William I; reform of the army; constitutional crisis, 1860–62; the impact of Bismarck's appointment. • Prussia's victory over Austria, 1862–1866: Bismarck's aims; Austrian attempts to reform the Confederation; significance of the Polish Revolt and Austro-Prussian intervention in Denmark; Bismarck's preparations for war; the significance of the Seven Weeks' War.
4 Prussia and the <i>Klein-deutschland</i> solution, 1866–71	• Prussia's role in Germany, 1866–67; the Treaty of Prague; the annexation of north German states; the North German Confederation; Prussia's relationship with south German states; creation of the <i>Zollparlament</i>; Bismarck and the National Liberals. • Prussia's relations with France, 1866–70: Napoleon III and Bismarck; significance of the Luxemburg Crisis, the Hohenzollern candidature and the Ems Telegram; outbreak of war; significance of the international situation 1870. • The significance of the Franco-Prussian War, including increased support for German nationalism, strengthening of Bismarck's position and the creation of a German Empire; the significance of the Treaty of Frankfurt 1871. • Reasons for Prussia's success, including the role of Bismarck, military strength, economic factors, German nationalism and the international situation.

Route E: Communist states in the twentieth century

Overview

Students taking Route E will study:

- *Paper 1, Option 1E: Russia, 1917–91: from Lenin to Yeltsin*

and **either**:

- *Paper 2, Option 2E.1: Mao's China, 1949–76*

or:

- *Paper 2, Option 2E.2: The German Democratic Republic, 1949–90.*

The options in Route E are linked by the theme of communism, one of the most significant ideologies of the twentieth century. Communism directly affected the lives of millions of people who lived under communist rule, but it also had indirect effects on countless others around the world.

Studying two different countries allows students to develop a greater understanding of the nature of communist rule and the similarities and contrasts between them (although students will not be required to answer comparative questions that link the breadth and the chosen depth option).